

# 140 YEAR ANNIVERSARY OF THE PROCLAMATION OF PETERBOROUGH AS A MUNICIPALITY - 1886 TO 2026

## 1882 - 1890

### 1882

About 40 people attended a meeting held in Yongala on 5<sup>th</sup> September 1882 to discuss forming a district council within the Hundred of Yongala. Mr W. N. Robinson convened the meeting and was called on by the chair Mr J. Ramsay J.P. to give his reasons for forming a district council. Reasons for and against were heard and it was decided to form a committee to evaluate the feelings of the inhabitants of not only the Hundred of Yongala, but also the neighbouring Hundreds of Morgan, Blackrock, and Mannanarie.

The formation of a district council was discussed at a meeting held at the Petersburg Hotel on Monday 25<sup>th</sup> September. As Petersburg was in the Hundred of Yongala, this would affect them and there was a great deal of talk for both sides. A proposition was carried; *"That the time had not arrived for the formation of a district council for the Hundred of Yongala, and that a counter memorial be got up as soon as possible."* A committee of nine gentlemen was appointed to follow up on the various propositions that had been adopted.

### 1883

In January 1883, a memorial by taxpayers of Petersburg was sent to the Government against the formation of a District Council for the Hundred of Yongala.

May it please your Excellency:  
We, your petitioners, hereby humbly shew—  
That we consider the idea of a District Council for Hundred of Yongala premature; and that, on account of the two bad seasons, we will be quite unable to pay the taxes incurred by a District Council.  
And we, as in duty bound, will ever pray.

|                  |                    |                       |
|------------------|--------------------|-----------------------|
| John Wright      | T. W. Waters       | Wm. Casey             |
| H. Green         | D. Fennell         | P. Crouley            |
| John Blunsden    | James Scroft       | Thomas Conlon         |
| W. Blunsden      | H. Critchley       | William Conlon        |
| H. Riddiford     | J. B. Jarvis       | John Anderson         |
| Richard Pomery   | T. Benet           | James Anderson        |
| Joseph Sullivan  | J. Hoar            | Peter Malycha         |
| Patrick Perry    | F. Kentish         | S. Malycha            |
| Rodger Perry     | Michael Lynch      | James C. R. McInerney |
| Patt Tyrell      | R. Coombs          | H. Koch               |
| Richard Cochrane | Patrick O'Neill    | W. Koch               |
| John Howard      | Duncan F. Cram     | Ad. Brank             |
| James Cummins    | William Pilkington | Richard Cheffers      |
| John McInerney   | M. Crotty          | F. Howley             |
| Thos. Liddy      | James Naughton     | M. Kelley             |
| Darby Liddy      | Richd. Nourse      | John M. Stephens.     |
| Edw. Mogenson    | S. Brooks          |                       |

*The South Australian Government Gazette*  
11 January 1883 p. 69

A proclamation in the Government Gazette announced the Hundred of Yongala to be called the District of Yongala and a district council was formed. The first meeting took place on Saturday 31<sup>st</sup> March 1883. Mr William Tickle was elected as Chairman and Petersburg was included in the Yongala District Council.

## 140 YEAR ANNIVERSARY OF THE PROCLAMATION OF PETERBOROUGH AS A MUNICIPALITY

SOUTH AUSTRALIA, } *Proclamation by His Excellency Sir WILLIAM*  
*to wit.* } *CLEAVER FRANCIS ROBINSON, Knight Com-*  
*(L.S.)* } *mander of the Most Distinguished Order of*  
 WILLIAM C. F. } *Saint Michael and Saint George, Governor and*  
 ROBINSON. } *Commander-in-Chief in and over the Province of*  
                   } *South Australia and the Dependencies thereof,*  
                   } *&c., &c., &c.*

WHEREAS a memorial has been presented to me, the said Governor, signed by not less than two-fifths of the ratepayers of the hundred of Yongala, praying that the same might be constituted a district, to be called the District of Yongala, and that the first councillors for the said district might be appointed: And whereas such memorial has been duly published for three successive weeks in the *Government Gazette*; and upon reading the said memorial I have determined to constitute the district of Yongala in the manner herein-after mentioned: Now therefore I, the Governor aforesaid, by and with the advice and consent of the Executive Council of the said province, and by virtue of the powers vested in me by the District Councils Act, 1876, and of all other powers and authorities me enabling, do hereby order, direct, and proclaim that, from the date hereof, the hundred of Yongala, the boundaries whereof are set forth in the schedule hereto, shall constitute a district, to be called the District of Yongala, within the meaning and for the purposes of the said Act: And I hereby appoint Messrs. William Tickle, Peter James Jonas, James Liddy, James Haworth, and Richard Jyack Glasson, to be the first councillors for the district of Yongala aforesaid.

SCHEDULE.—DISTRICT OF YONGALA.

Comprising the whole of the hundred of Yongala, bounded on the north by the south boundary of the hundred of Morgan; on the east by the west boundary of the hundred of Gumbowie; on the south by the north boundary of the hundred of Whyte; and on the west, by the east boundary of the hundred of Mannanarie.

Given under my hand and the public seal of the said province, at Adelaide, this seventh day of March, in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and eighty-three, and in the forty-sixth year of Her Majesty's reign.

By command,  
 J. C. BRAY, Chief Secretary.

GOD SAVE THE QUEEN!

*The South Australian Government Gazette*  
 8 March 1883, p. 850

# 1884

Another memorial by taxpayers from Petersburg was sent to the Government against the formation of a District Council for the Hundred of Yongala in January 1884. Some of the hottest temperatures experienced for years in January and February 1884 gave way to a heavy thunderstorm in early March flooded the streets. It was noted that the road into Petersburg was in a very bad condition and that the Yongala District Council while happy to take rates were not interested in the upkeep concerning Petersburg.

Most of the road from Dawson to Petersburg was in a disgraceful state and many farmers had chosen to hold onto their wheat rather than try to transport it along this road. Wagons with teams of sixteen or more horses attached had been known to be stuck there for hours. The settlers approached the local Members of Parliament to have the road placed on the Schedule of Main Roads, which would repair roads outside of District Councils. Part of the road came under the Yongala Council, and they would have to repair that portion, which they were reluctant to do.

A public meeting was held on 27<sup>th</sup> June at Hoar's Hotel to discuss several local wants. A letter was to be sent to the Mayor of Port Pirie asking that the petition adopted by Port Pirie on 25<sup>th</sup> June stating that the railway to the Barrier Ranges (N.S.W.) starting at Petersburg be forwarded to them so more signatures can be added. The meeting also discussed the idea of having the District Council of Yongala divided into wards. A letter was sent to the council.

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At the next public meeting on 19<sup>th</sup> July, it was decided to petition the Government for permission to form Petersburg into a corporate town. Rivalry and jealousy had always existed between Yongala and Petersburg, and the people of Petersburg did not think it was fair that rates collected from them were used to benefit Yongala. Mr Threadgold was nominated as mayor for the proposed corporation, and it was suggested that there be two wards, North and South. Three councillors were nominated for each ward: Messrs Hosking, Cochrane and H. Koch for South Ward and Messrs. Callary, Hoar, and Wright for North Ward.

A memorial signed by the Councillors from the District of Yongala and about 100 ratepayers was sent to the Governor objecting to the proposed Petersburg Corporation. They also requested that the present Council district be divided into three wards.

By the end of November an agitation for a separation from Yongala District Council and the formation of a corporation was proceeding.

There had been much debate on whether the railway to the Barrier Ranges should run from Petersburg or from Terowie. There was rivalry between the two towns and petitions from many parties had been lobbied in Parliament

Tensions between Petersburg and Yongala were becoming more evident when the Yongala District Council declined to “lavish sixpence” on Petersburg and spend any spare ratepayer’s money on upgrading Yongala.

Port Augusta Dispatch  
Monday 1<sup>st</sup> December 1884

The Yongala District Council does not view the city of Petersburg with favor. When requested to spend a portion of the rates paid by the Petersburgites on improving the streets of the town, the councillors emphatically declined, remarking that if they had any money to spare they would metal both sides of Yongala-street rather than lavish sixpence on Petersburg.

On 17<sup>th</sup> December a proclamation in the Government Gazette directed that “*The District Council of Yongala shall be divided into three wards, namely, Petersburg, Yongala, and South-East Wards, each ward returning two Councillors, and defining the boundaries of each ward.*” Mr Jonathon Hoar and Mr Richard Cochrane were elected for Petersburg Ward.

### 1885

With the new railway to Silverton being built in 1885 many unemployed men found work building the railway reservoirs at Petersburg, Gumbowie, Parnaroo and Nackara. On 5<sup>th</sup> March one hundred and four unemployed men arrived by special train from Adelaide via Terowie. Mr Dyke the works manager had five wagons waiting to transport some of the men to the Seven-Mile camp and some to the Fifteen-Mile camp.

About sixty men from the Fifteen-Mile Camp were moved to the camp in Petersburg in May and this caused many more problems in the once quiet town. There were often drunken brawls and street fights amongst the workers. lively. The workers were camped down by the reservoir which was to be enlarged.

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A few boarding houses had opened but some of these were found to be very unhygienic and were shut down. New guidelines were passed, and boarding houses had to be registered, and regular inspections were done by the Corporation.

Correspondence from the meeting of the Central Board of Health on Tuesday 9<sup>th</sup> June 1885 shows a report from the local Health Inspector. He had inspected both Yongala and Petersburg and stated at the time that Yongala and its suburbs consisted of about ninety dwellings with a population of 350, compared to Petersburg with a population of about 300 with seventy dwellings. This was a drop from the official 1881 census.

The natural drainage in the town was defective although works were in progress to improve this. Large quantities of household refuse were being left to decompose and the depot fixed by the council was not being used. Most privies were unsatisfactory, with cesspits being merely holes in the ground from five to six feet deep, and many of them in a foul state.

At the October meeting of the Yongala District Council, it was reported that a new site for rubbish removal was being arranged. Footpaths in Main Street and Railway Street were to be built.

At a town meeting in the Institute on 23<sup>rd</sup> October there was debate on which side of the railway line a road from Petersburg to Terowie should run. Voters for the eastern side contended that the entrance and exit to and from the Main Street was the better route. The argument for the western side was that the entrance and exit would be in the centre of the town, which would suit more people. Forty-nine voted for the western side and thirty-five for the eastern side. Messrs Koch Bros offered land for this road.

John Blunsden, Philip Callary and Robert McPherson were elected for the Petersburg Ward on the Yongala District Council.

"Petersburg consists of about seventy dwellings, with a population of about 300. The natural drainage is defective, the site of the township being flat and low, but works are now in progress which when finished will improve the drainage of the main thoroughfare. This is being formed, drained, and metalled by the Local Board of Main Roads. The water supply is obtained from wells and tanks, principally the latter. The wells are 90 to 100 feet deep, and the water is said to be pure and wholesome. Underground tanks are well constructed, and the entrances are protected from surface impurities. Milk is supplied from a dairy close by, the surroundings of which, as well as the milk vessels, were in a clean and well-kept condition. Large quantities of house refuse are scattered about some private premises. This is left to decompose where it accumulated, and although the District Council has fixed a depot near the township for the deposit of rubbish, it is not used. If householders are unable to get rubbish carted away, it should be collected in a heap and burned. Filthy and unpaved pigsties are a source of nuisance in the town-

ship. The dwellings facing the principal street with privy, pigsties, &c., occupy quarter-of-acre blocks of land. The majority of the privies are unsatisfactory, cesspits being merely holes in ground from five to six feet deep, and many of them were in a foul state. There are two slaughtering establishments—one a short distance outside the township, the other near the main street. They were both unsatisfactory, and causing a nuisance. In November, 1883, by-laws were passed by the District Council for the prevention of nuisances in the township, and for a short time a local Inspector of Nuisances was employed, but six months since he resigned, and no one has been appointed to succeed him. The township has been brought under the local provisions of the Police Act. I inspected sixty places and served twenty-eight notices under the Board's regulations, and have given details of nuisances requiring to be dealt with by orders from the Board."

The Board directed the Secretary to issue thirty-four orders for abatement of nuisances, and to write to those persons on whom the Inspector had served notices and allow them twenty-one days to remove all nuisances from their respective premises.

*Adelaide Observer*  
*Saturday 13<sup>th</sup> June 1885*

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### 1886

A large meeting of ratepayers was held at the Institute on Friday 9<sup>th</sup> March 1886 for the purpose of forming Petersburg into a corporation town. A deputation was being sent to Adelaide, and this matter was to be added. Mr William Threadgold was elected Mayor of the proposed council, with the following gentlemen elected as Councillors: East Ward; Messrs J. Wright and Edward Mogensen, West Ward; Messrs William Howard and Philip A. Callary M.P., South Ward; Messrs Thomas Hosking and William Heithersay. It was proposed that the incorporated district be bounded on the north by Section 218, on the south by Section 216, on the east by the Terowie Road and on the west by the railway crossing and from thence by Mr Cochrane's paddock. The boundaries of the three proposed wards were the Main Street to divide North and South Wards, and High Street to divide the East and West Wards.

Chief Secretary's Office, Adelaide, June 1st, 1886.

**H**IS Excellency the Governor directs the publication of the following memorial for general information.

By command,  
J. C. BRAY, Chief Secretary.

*Third publication.]*

To His Excellency Sir WILLIAM CLEAVER FRANCIS ROBINSON,  
*Knight Commander of the Most Distinguished Order of St. Michael and St. George, Governor and Commander-in-Chief in and over the Province of South Australia and the Dependencies thereof.*

The petition of the undersigned (not being less than two-fifths of the ratepayers), ratepayers of the township of Petersburg (the proposed municipality) in the province of South Australia:

Humbly sheweth—

That your petitioners are desirous of being incorporated under the provisions of the Municipal Corporation Act, No. 190 of 1880, under the style of the Corporation of Petersburg.

That your petitioners have agreed that the boundaries of the said municipality shall be delineated in the accompanying plan, in red ink, marked A, to this petition annexed.

That the said corporate town shall be divided into three wards, to be known respectively as the South, East, and West wards, and that the said wards shall be as divided as follows, viz.:—South ward shall comprise the whole of section No. 216, and the East ward and West ward shall be divided by High-street, Petersburg.

That the land included in the said proposed boundaries is the site of the township of Petersburg, and that the said township is rapidly growing in size and importance.

That the population within the proposed municipality is now so great that your petitioners humbly submit that, for the proper carrying out of sanitary arrangements and necessary local improvements, a corporation is far more suitable than a district council.

That your petitioners respectfully request that your Excellency may be pleased to declare and proclaim the boundaries described in the annexed schedule B a corporation under the provisions of the said Act, No. 190 of 1880, accordingly.

That your petitioners beg to nominate the following ratepayers to be mayor and councillors for the said corporation of Petersburg:—For mayor—William Threadgold, storekeeper; for councillors—South ward, Messrs. Thomas Hosking and William Heithersay, both of Petersburg; East ward, Jabez Wright and Edward Mogensen, both of Petersburg; West ward, Messrs. Philip A. Callary and William Howard, both of Petersburg; for auditors, Messrs. A. T. Threadgold and Frederick Kentish, both of Petersburg.

And your petitioners, as in duty bound, will ever pray, &c., &c.

|                      |                     |                        |
|----------------------|---------------------|------------------------|
| J. J. Laurie         | P. A. Callary, J.P. | Wm. Howard             |
| T. W. Waters         | G. Holland          | C. Cleashey            |
| W. M. Dale           | Rowe Bros.          | J. Campbell            |
| G. W. Klem           | W. Smith            | A. Dowd                |
| A. A. Porter         | J. Smith            | G. Howard              |
| C. V. L. Florance    | Holder & Torrington | Gordon Hall, for       |
| J. Wright            | W. A. Jones         | National Bank          |
| W. Heithersay        | W. H. Scott         | E. R. Baird            |
| J. R. Hill           | H. W. Hodgetts      | John H. Norton         |
| T. Hosking           | J. Conway           | J. Anderson            |
| A. T. Threadgold     | S. Malycha          | Jos. Richardson        |
| E. Mogenson          | Jos. Acres          | W. S. Ferry            |
| C. Hansen            | Thos. Fay           | A. E. Ferry            |
| L. Levine            | B. J. Knight        | Elizabeth Jackson      |
| S. Garrett           | J. Waters           | J. W. Jackson          |
| Wm. Threadgold, J.P. | W. Smith            | W. Forgan              |
| F. Kentish           | W. J. S. Newman     | J. & R. Forgan         |
| M. Kelly             | A. Brauer           | J. Hoar                |
| J. Prater            | Geo. Randle         | Thos. Rowe             |
| M. Coen              | W. B. Johnson       | W. Harvey              |
| J. Owens             | H. H. Rohde         | John Canny             |
| W. Osborne           | R. Pitchford        | Trustees Malcolm's     |
| T. Nelson            | J. Patten           | estate by their agent, |
| F. V. Brady          | C. H. Lane          | H. Robinson            |
| A. Schulz            | J. Lademann         | M. Doswell             |
| W. Rohde             | W. Koch             | J. Kildea              |
| A. Dungey            | J. H. Koch          | E. S. & A. C. Bank     |
| J. H. Sheridan       | T. Newman           |                        |
| T. Nelson, sen.      | J. Heithersay       |                        |

The schedule B referred to in the annexed petition of ratepayers in the township of Petersburg:—

The boundaries of the proposed municipality of Petersburg—Commencing at the north-western corner of section 216; thence to south-west corner of same section; thence easterly to south-east corner of same section; thence north-easterly along west side of Terowie-road to north-eastern corner of section 219; thence westerly to north-east corner of section 217; thence southerly along eastern boundary of section 217 to the north-eastern boundary of the township of Petersburg west; thence westerly to north-west corner of said township; thence southerly to south-west corner of said township; thence south-westerly along the railway line to point of departure.

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Petersburg became a corporate town on Tuesday 5<sup>th</sup> October 1886. The Mayor W. Threadgold and Councillors; Messrs Callary, Howard, Hosking, Wright, and Heithersay were sworn in at a ceremony at the Institute with Mr James Ramsay J.P. presiding. Mr Nelson was nominated for East Ward. Mr J. R. Hill was the first Town Clerk. Mr Callary resigned from the Petersburg Ward on the Yongala District Council.

**PETERSBURG, MONDAY, OCTOBER 11.**  
The ceremony of swearing-in the Mayor and Councillors of Petersburg Corporation took place in the Institute. Mr. Ramsay, J.P., presided. The following gentlemen were sworn in:—Messrs. W. Threadgold, J.P., as Mayor, and Messrs. Callary, Howard, Hosking, Wright, and Heithersay as Councillors. Mr. Nelson was nominated vice Mr. Ingerson for East Ward.

*Evening Journal*  
Tuesday 12 October 1886

Mr William Threadgold  
First mayor of Petersburg



Another meeting was held on Thursday 18<sup>th</sup> November concerning the extension of the broad-gauge to Petersburg, and the necessity of having a local court in the town. It was thought that the government could lay a third line from Terowie or widen the present one. It was argued that as Petersburg Junction was destined to become a large traffic centre and it would cost the government three times as much in the future for any land required for railway purposes.

### 1887

Many residents were dissatisfied with the rateable value of their properties the Petersburg Corporation were charging. The one advantage of having their own council was that hopefully the work needed around the town that the District Council of Yongala kept disregarding would be done. "Clean footpaths and nice streets, instead of the wretched mud walk in winter, and blinding clouds of dust from unmade roads in summer," was one of the hopes.

There are a number of people in the town dissatisfied with the action of the Corporation in arriving at the rateable value of the property. It is not altogether whether what has been done is for the general good, but there is a feeling existing that what has been performed is not altogether in accord with the Act. However this may be none cannot but recognise the advantage of local government, and when the preliminaries are all dispensed with, and work begun, the people will no doubt appreciate having clean footpaths and nice streets, instead of the wretched mud-walk in winter, and blinding clouds of dust from unmade roads in summer. We are in hopes that everything will work smoothly, but it is provoking that we should require to wait until Parliament has been called together before we can get our bye-laws assented to by the Governor. In the meantime I understand that Mr. Hill, the Town Clerk, is making enquiries as to some definite course of action.

*The Terowie Enterprise*  
Friday 28<sup>th</sup> January 1887

An article in the Port Augusta Dispatch on Tuesday 8<sup>th</sup> March stated that the Corporation of Petersburg was going a bit overboard with their 15 pages of by-laws in the Gazette. Below is a section of the 15 pages of By-laws by the newly formed Petersburg Corporation.

The new-fledged Corporation of Petersburg stands a risk of being by-lawed to death. Its proposed by-laws fill 15 pages of last week's Gazette.

The Port Augusta Dispatch  
Tuesday 8<sup>th</sup> March 1887

March 3, 1887.]

THE SOUTH AUSTRALIAN GOVERNMENT GAZETTE.

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3. Every bicyclist who rides a bicycle during the hours between sunset and sunrise shall carry attached to his bicycle a lamp, which shall be so constructed and placed as to exhibit a red light in the direction in which he is proceeding, and shall be so lighted, and kept lighted, as to afford adequate means of signalling the approach or position of such bicycle.

4. Every bicyclist, when riding or propelling a bicycle, shall carry or have a bell large enough to be heard at a distance of fifty yards, and such bell shall be kept continually ringing.

5. Not more than two bicyclists shall ride abreast, and only one bicyclist shall pass a carriage or person at the same time.

6. In every case where a bicyclist meets or overtakes any wagon, cart, carriage, or vehicle, or any horse, mule, or other beast of burden, and where, by reason of such meeting or overtaking, any animal drawing such wagon, cart, carriage, or vehicle, or such horse, mule, or other beast of burden, may become restive or alarmed, or may cease to be under the due control of the person for the time being in charge of such wagon, cart, carriage, or vehicle, or of such horse, mule, or other beast of burden, such bicyclist shall dismount as speedily as possible, and shall continue dismounted so long as may be reasonably necessary to avoid accident.

Every person who breaks any of the foregoing by-laws shall be liable for any one offence to a fine not being less than five shillings and not exceeding ten pounds.

BY-LAW No. 30.—*To prevent the letting-off of firearms, or fireworks, or lighting, or causing to be lighted, any fire in the town of Petersburg.*

Any person who shall at any time light, or suffer to be lighted, any fire in the open air in the said town, without having first obtained the consent of the town clerk, or who shall discharge any firearm, or let off any firework in, along, or across any public road, street, or thoroughfare within the municipality, shall on conviction for every such offence forfeit and pay a penalty of not less than five shillings nor more than five pounds.

BY-LAW No. 31.—*Regulations for licensed saleyards and carriage bazaars in the town of Petersburg.*

Yearly licences.

1. Annual licences may be granted to the owner, proprietor, or occupier of suitable premises, situated within the said town, to be used and occupied as saleyards, and the fee, until otherwise determined, shall be three pounds three shillings per annum, payable in advance on receipt of licence, signed by the town clerk.

Regulations to be carried out or renewal refused.

2. No licence shall be renewed to any person or persons who shall refuse or omit to carry out the conditions or regulations hereinafter provided, or against whom any complaint shall be lodged in respect of his licensed premises, or otherwise, until the granting of such renewal shall have been first sanctioned by the council.

Good and sufficient yards to be provided.

3. The persons to be licensed as aforesaid shall provide good and sufficient yards and enclosures for the protection of the public from horses or cattle placed therein, and the same shall be to the satisfaction of the council, or of such officer as may be appointed to inspect them; and all such yards or other enclosures shall, previous to a licence being granted, be inspected by the officer appointed for that purpose.

Sale days.

4. All sales at such licensed places shall take place during the usual or customary business hours of the day.

By-law to be adhered to.

5. By-law No. 9.—“To regulate the driving, &c., of horses and horned cattle through the town of Petersburg,” shall be strictly adhered to.

Licensed premises to be properly kept.

6. The licensed premises shall be kept fit for use, and shall from time to time be properly cleansed to the satisfaction of the inspectors, sanitary inspectors, or other officers of the said council.

Penalty.

7. Any person infringing these conditions and regulations, or any of them, shall forfeit and pay for each offence a sum not being less than five shillings and not exceeding five pounds.

PARK LANDS REGULATIONS.

BY-LAW No. 32.—*A by-law made and ordained by the council of the corporation of the town of Petersburg for the management, care, and control of the park lands, reserves, and places of public recreation for the time being vested in the corporation or under their care, control, or management.*

Appointment of park rangers and keepers, or servants.

1. The council may from time to time appoint and employ park lands rangers, or keepers of the park lands, and other servants, for maintaining and watching over the said park lands, reserves, and places of public recreation, as they may deem necessary.

Park rangers, keepers, and police may remove offenders.

2. The park lands rangers, keepers, or other servants appointed as aforesaid, police constables, and special constables, shall be at liberty to remove all persons from the park lands offending against any of these by-laws.

Park lands to be open.

3. The park lands and places of public recreation shall at all times, subject to any special rights granted by the council respecting recreation grounds, and except as provided by special Act or otherwise specially hereinafter provided for, be open for the admission of the public.

Persons not to ride over the park lands.

4. No person shall ride in, upon, or over the said park lands or public reserves, or any part thereof (other than a carriage-way), without permission from the council first obtained, except in exercise of any special right granted by the council in respect to recreation grounds.

5. No cart or other vehicle used for the conveyance of goods shall, without the authority of the council first obtained, be driven through the park lands or public reserves.

Injuring or destroying trees.

6. No person shall injure, cut, break, deface, pull up, remove, or destroy any tree, shrub, or plant, growing on the said park lands or public reserves.

Injuring the soil, or surface, or fences.

7. No person or persons shall cut up, or damage, or disfigure, or interfere with the soil or turf or surface of any part of the said park lands or reserves, or the roads or footways across, around, or over the same, or with any part of the fences around or upon the same in any manner whatsoever without the written consent of the council first obtained.

Persons misconducting themselves.

8. No person shall misconduct himself in any way by indulging in any riotous or indecent conduct, or make use of any indecent or improper language on the said park lands or public reserves.

Lodging on the park lands in the open air.

9. No person shall camp, lodge, or tarry overnight, or frequent for the purpose of camping, lodging, or tarrying overnight, in the open air on the said park lands or reserves, or under the shade or shelter of any tree or trees, or on any seat on the said park lands or reserves, without the written consent of the council first obtained.

Posting bills.

10. No person shall post, stick, stamp, stencil, paint, or otherwise affix, or cause to be posted, stuck, stamped, stencilled, painted, or otherwise affixed, any placard, handbill, notice, advertisement, or any document whatsoever upon any tree, fence, post, gate, wall, flagging, or path on the said park lands or public reserves.

Shooting, &c., on the park lands.

11. No person or persons shall shoot or discharge any firearms, or throw or discharge any stone or other missile, or set off any fire balloon, or throw or set fire to any fireworks, or kindle or make any fire, on any portion of the park lands or reserves without the written consent of the council first obtained.

Selling goods on the park lands.

12. No person shall sell or expose for sale any goods, wares, merchandise, or things on any portion of the said park lands or reserves, unless the consent in writing of the said council shall be previously obtained.

Dangerous games not to be played.

13. No racing matches with horses, dogs, or otherwise, nor any game of polo, nor any game which may be considered dangerous, or may be calculated to interfere with the safety or comfort of the general public, or likely to injure the surface of the ground, shall be allowed on the said park lands or reserves, except on such portions as may be specially set apart for such purposes, and shown thereon by boundary posts, such

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With the formation of the Corporation, by May 1887 the town was beginning to look a little more shipshape with all vacant allotments having to be fenced in. Road making had been tended for and would commence soon. Townsfolk had taken advantage of the good season, and many planted gardens and applications had been made to the Conservator of Forests for a number of trees for planting purposes. Business had been quiet, as expected for that time of the year, and all were looking forward to the prospect of a good season.

### ***The Petersburg Times***

Bitter rivalry between Petersburg and Terowie over where the break of gauge should be located prompted the movement in favour of a local newspaper, as it was felt that Petersburg was at a disadvantage over Terowie who had a local paper 'The Terowie Enterprise' published by Mr J. S. Pengelly.

Mr Threadgold (Mayor of Petersburg) approached Mr Robert M. Osborne of Adelaide to establish a paper in Petersburg. Mr Osborne agreed and brought printing machinery to Petersburg to start a local newspaper. A venue for the printing press could not be found after the Union Church was unavailable, so Mr Heithersay kindly lent a small unlined, dirt floored iron building at the rear of his machinery business premises in Main Street. The paper was printed in this small iron building near the Mill Street Crossing until a more suitable location was found in Railway Street.

The first edition of the Petersburg Times, Orroroo Chronicle, and Northern Advertiser was printed on Friday 12<sup>th</sup> August 1887. It featured an article on Messrs Heithersay Bros stump jumping plough, local news, and advertising for many of the businesses in Petersburg. The paper was four pages long.

Tensions between the towns of Petersburg and Yongala, Petersburg and Terowie, and Petersburg and Lancelot were increasing with the topics of a loop line for the Silverton Railway, a local court for Petersburg, a new broad-gauge line to Petersburg and the lack of growth in Lancelot and Yongala in September 1887.

A meeting of ratepayers was held on Tuesday 22<sup>nd</sup> November 1887. The meeting called by the Mayor; Mr William Threadgold was in response to a numerously signed requisition to hear the Auditors report of the Corporation's first municipal year in Petersburg. There had been a considerable amount of dissatisfaction with the council for not fulfilling the requirements of the Municipal Act in reference to the preparations of the ratepayers' roll, the delay of the yearly audit, and the non-advertising of the prospective receipts and expenditures. There were several new candidates for the council. The meeting was described by one journalist as "*a sort of Civil War in Petersburg over Municipal Affairs.*"

## 140 YEAR ANNIVERSARY OF THE PROCLAMATION OF PETERBOROUGH AS A MUNICIPALITY

Elections for the Corporation were held for the first time as the original councillors were elected at a meeting. Mr W. Threadgold was elected as Mayor, and the Councillors elected were Messrs Heithersay, Howard, Klem, Wright, Osborne, and Callary.

### **The Municipal Elections.**

The first elections in the history of the Petersburg Corporation occurred yesterday, and it is gratifying to us to state that the arrangements of the day were most successfully carried out. Forsometime prior to the elections it was felt that the contest would be a keen one, and such anticipations were certainly verified by the result. During the last few weeks the actions of the late Council have been freely criticised, and it was felt by many ratepayers—and, indeed, was admitted by the Council—that things during the past municipal year had been carried out in a rather loose manner, and it seemed reasonable to suppose that the infusion of a little new blood into the Council Chamber would be productive of good. It has also been urged, and we think correctly, that even if things are carried out to the

satisfaction of every ratepayer, it is yet advisable at the annual elections to elect new men whenever practicable, providing of course that suitable candidates can be obtained. Such a course serves to bring our public men to the front, and induces aspiring ratepayers to qualify themselves for the posts to which they aspire to attain, and in this way a healthy spirit of rivalry is created.

The greatest interest in the recent elections of course centred round the Mayoralty. Mr. W. Threadgold, J.P., is a very old resident of the township and has been closely associated with its growth and development, and is deservedly popular. His opponent, Mr. Copinger, has been more recently connected with the town, but since his arrival amongst us has gained the goodwill and esteem of all who have been brought in contact with him. When the poll was declared it

was found that the voting had been close indeed, Mr. Threadgold scoring 45 against Mr. Copinger's 43. As there were 2 informal votes in East Ward, and one of them the Returning Officer informs us was evidently meant for the latter gentleman, Mr. Threadgold's majority is virtually reduced to 1 vote.

The voting for Councillors in the various Wards was also very close, the greatest discrepancy being manifested in West Ward, where Mr. P. A. Callary was opposed to Mr. J. H. Touchell, the latter receiving 14 votes against his opponent's 26. The voting in East Ward resulted in a tie between Messrs. Wright and Rudland, but as it was apparent to the Returning Officer that the one informal vote registered in this Ward was meant for Mr. Wright he acted wisely in giving that gentleman his casting vote. The least interest was manifested in

South Ward, and this probably arose from the fact that here the contest was made less a party matter than in the other two wards. The result of the voting placed Mr. G. W. Klem at the head of the poll with 13 votes, his opponent, Mr. C. Preece, receiving 8.

Now that the elections are over we trust that any friction that has existed will be relegated to the past. The successful candidates have been for the most part returned by bare majorities, and it is evident that the defeated men, as well as their more successful opponents, possess a very large share of the public confidence. On the one side it is a well-earned victory and on the other an honorable defeat, and we trust the matter will be thus allowed to rest.

Of one thing we are assured, and that is the work of the new Council will be attentively watched by the ratepayers during the coming municipal year.

*Petersburg Times*  
Friday 2 December 1887

## 1888

Mr J. H. Touchell was voted as Town Clerk in January, and he took over from Mr J. R. Hill. The councillors voted to provide an office for the town clerk and that it should be big enough to hold their meetings in, and that the corporation have the whole and sole control over it.

The council voted to assist any firm starting a new industry in Petersburg and that they would take steps necessary to have the town declared a manufacturing district. Councillors Callary, Heithersay, Klem and Osborne were elected to a committee to promote this idea. Mr Howard the new Councillor for the East Ward was fined at a council meeting for calling the council a fraud over the election of Mr Touchell as town clerk as he felt the proceedings had been carried out unfairly. This fine was later rescinded.

The secretary to the Petersburg Board of Health wrote to the secretary of the Local Board of Health, Adelaide after complaints to the resident engineer Mr Stephens at the railway yard were ignored. Mr Touchell wrote that two distinct and separate nuisances existed on the railway premises at Petersburg.

## 140 YEAR ANNIVERSARY OF THE PROCLAMATION OF PETERBOROUGH AS A MUNICIPALITY

By 1888 the population of Petersburg had increased to approximately 800. A report by the Board of Health Chief Inspector Mr Farrell, pointed out that little had been done to improve the sanitary condition of Petersburg.

The Secretary to the board of health at Petersburg wrote, stating that two distinct and separate nuisances exist on the railway premises at Petersburg. One nuisance is an open drain which is used for carrying off the waste water employed in cleansing the engines. The water is stagnant in the drain, and in the opinion of the local board is injurious to health. A bottle full of foul matter taken from the drain was forwarded. The other nuisance is a large oblong hole dug in the station-yard, about 50 yards from the passenger station, into which the contents of the station closets are emptied without the excreta being properly covered. The local board had served a notice on the stationmaster to abate the nuisance, and some correspondence had passed between the Government officials and the local board of health, but nothing had been done towards complying with the notice of the latter. The Central Board was therefore requested to take the matter up. The Secretary was instructed to inform the local board that the Central Board has no power to compel the Government to comply with orders from local boards; but that the Health Acts provided ample authority for local boards to enforce obedience to any order properly made, whether against the Government or private individuals.

Petersburg Times  
Friday 13 January 1888

### THE PETERSBURG CEMETERY. MEETING IN THE INSTITUTE HALL. - Petersburg Times – Friday 20<sup>th</sup> April

*A public meeting—called by the mayor, at the request of a large number of ratepayers—was held in the Institute Hall, Petersburg, on Wednesday evening last to consider the difficulties which have lately arisen with regard to the management of the local cemetery.*

*There was a fair attendance, and the mayor was voted to the chair, whilst Mr Limbert acted as secretary.*

*The Chairman said that the difficulties under which the Committee of management laboured were caused by the absence from the colony of two of the trustees the curator and the Secretary—which latter had gone over the border, taking all the money, books, and documents with him. The corporation had at their last meeting expressed themselves agreeable to take over the cemetery and as the trustees were willing to transfer their interest their appeared to be no difficulty in the way of this being done. A curator had been appointed (pro term) that afternoon.*

*At present there was a strip of land about 5 chains long between the cemetery and the Corporation boundaries but that the proprietors had consented to have transferred to the Corporation.*

## 140 YEAR ANNIVERSARY OF THE PROCLAMATION OF PETERBOROUGH AS A MUNICIPALITY

The Local Board of Health had begun to fine the many townsfolk who had ignored their notices for the abatement of nuisances and until now had treated the Board with indifference. Mr Thomas Williams of the Petersburg Hotel was fined at the Police Court £3 11s for abusive language and assault on the Secretary of the Local Board of Health.

### **The Sanitary Condition of Petersburg.**

#### **CHIEF - INSPECTOR FARRELL'S REPORT TO THE CENTRAL BOARD OF HEALTH.**

"Since I last inspected this town in June, 1885, it has been separated from the district of Yongala, and was incorporated in 1886. The population has increased from 350 in 1885 to its present estimated number of 800. Very little has yet been done to improve the naturally defective drainage of the town, a few side streets have been formed and metalled, but the waterchannels have not been paved. A good deal yet remains to be done to assist in carrying off storm waters and ordinary surface drainage. The Chairman of the Local Board of Health informed me that the Board hopes next year to be in a better financial position, when further improvements will be carried out. A scavenger has been appointed, who is required to visit each dwelling-house once a week and remove accumulated refuse, but he does not perform his work in a satisfactory manner. His contract expires next month, when fresh tenders will be called for scavenging. House and other refuse are removed to a fixed depot, which is situated in a suitable position to the west of the town. There is a good deal of bones, rags, and other objectionable refuse to be seen about the surroundings of premises, principally those on the north side of the main street. A number of vacant allotments are also littered with waste matter thrown on to them from adjoining dwellings. The Local Board of Health should give their attention to this matter, and have the refuse removed without delay. The scavenger is also licensed nightman, and attends to the cleansing of privy cesspools when required. Nightsoil is disposed of at the refuse depot.

I examined the spot, and found it in a satisfactory condition. I heard it mentioned that some of the residents are in the habit of burying nightsoil on their respective premises. This should not be permitted in a populous locality, and the Local Board have ample power under the Health Acts to prevent this being done. A large number of privies were in an unsatisfactory condition. The cesspits are large and deep, and many of them were quite uncovered, which allows effluvia to escape freely. Many of the superstructures also are in need of being put in decent repair. Some dwellings were without any privy accommodation. The Secretary of the Local Board (Mr J. H. Touchell) informed me that notices had been served by him, he being also local Sanitary inspector, for the removal of nuisances, and that some of these had been disregarded, and on the matter being reported to the Local Board of Health no further steps were taken to remove the nuisances. From February, 1887, to date only twenty three notices have been served. There is only one slaughter-house within the town boundaries, and in connection with this there is a piggery. I found these premises in a dirty and offensive condition. The Local Board should serve a continuous order on the occupier to keep the premises clean and free of nuisance. There are no cowyards here. The milk supply is brought in from a farm some distance beyond the town. The water supply is obtained from wells and tanks. Wells are 80 to 100 feet deep; they are all raised to the height of 2 or 3 feet above the surrounding level, so that no impurities can get washed into them; they are sunk almost the whole depth through a stiff clay subsoil, and in my opinion the water is not likely to be polluted by scum. Under-ground tanks are also well constructed, but I am afraid sufficient attention is not given to cleansing

toem regularly; that at the State school, for instance, has not been cleaned out for five years. There are 113 children on the school roll who drink water from this tank. The town is free from contagious diseases, and so far as I could learn the general health of the residents is good. For some time past a number of persons who have been known and others suspected to be suffering from typhoid fever have arrived at Petersburg from Broken Hill. Some of these have gone to a private hospital at Jamestown; others have gone either to the Burra or Port Augusta Hospitals. If a patient is known to be suffering from typhoid fever when he leaves Broken Hill he is put into a separate van there, and on arrival at Petersburg the railway station-master communicates with the railway officials at Terowie, and a separate van is provided there also; but it frequently happens that sick persons are travelling, and if the disease from which they are suffering is not known they travel in the ordinary passenger carriages. The express train from Broken Hill arrives at Petersburg about 6 a.m., and stays twelve to fifteen minutes; the ordinary passenger train arrives about noon, and stays twenty minutes, so that there is ample time for the privies at the railway station to be used by persons who are ill. Pans are used, which the stationmaster informed me are emptied regularly every evening; the contents are disposed of in a deep pit, and are covered with dry earth. Freshlime is also used freely on the deposit in the pans. The Local Board of Health meet every fortnight. A health rate of 2d in the pound has been levied, which amounts to £46 16s 4d. There is no Officer of Health. Mr Touchell, who accompanied me during my inspection, has only been connected with the Local Board since January last."

*Petersburg Times  
Friday 4 May 1888*

Mr Callary proposed that a petition be presented to His Excellency the Governor praying that he will alter the boundaries of Petersburg by adding to the South ward section 215 in the Hundred of Yongala.

A conference of delegations from various northern municipalities was held in the Institute Hall, at Petersburg on Saturday 2<sup>nd</sup> June 1888. The meeting was chaired by the Mayor Mr W. Threadgold and was held to consider the question of the Barrier trade. Mayors and representatives from Port Pirie, Port Augusta, Jamestown, Gladstone, Petersburg, and Orroroo were present, as well as the Hon W. Copley and J. Darling M.L.C.

## 140 YEAR ANNIVERSARY OF THE PROCLAMATION OF PETERBOROUGH AS A MUNICIPALITY

The Mayor of Port Augusta (Mr D. Drysdale) opened the proceedings pointing out that the residents of that town felt that the Adelaide press seemed to forget that their Port even existed. He stated that while £170,000 had been spent of Port Adelaide and only £55,000 on Port Augusta, the shipping facilities of the latter were far superior. He felt that they were not getting a fair share of the rail traffic from the Barrier Ranges and Port Pirie was getting more than they needed. They did not wish to 'rob' Port Pirie or Petersburg of trade but felt that a railway line could be constructed from Mannahill or Winnininnie to Carrieton, and smelting works erected at Port Augusta. He felt that Port Pirie already had an established trade and would lose nothing, whereas if they allowed the line to be tapped south of Petersburg it would mean that all the trade would go to Port Adelaide. A discussion followed and the Hon. W. Copley was glad to find that the northern towns, and especially the seaports, were working so well together.

The Mayor and Councillors of Petersburg, accompanied by the Town Clerk, met the Railway Commissioners at the Petersburg Railway Station on Thursday 7<sup>th</sup> June 1888 on the arrival of a special train from Port Pirie. The meeting was to point out the urgent need of an over-way pass bridge, and other local wants. The Mayor pointed out that the station was on the wrong side of the line and all passengers had to cross over the rails.

### **An Overway Bridge for Petersburg.**

Yesterday afternoon the Mayor, and Councillors of Petersburg accompanied by the Town Clerk and a representative of this paper, met the Railway Commissioners and party at the Petersburg Station on the arrival of the special train from Port Pirie, in order to point out the urgent need that existed for the erection of an overway bridge, and other local wants.

Mr McArthur kindly introduced the deputation to the Commissioners.

Mr Smith (Chairman of Commission) explained that as his party were on a flying visit of inspection the time that could be spared in Petersburg must necessarily be brief.

The Mayor (Mr W. Threadgold)

referred to the fact of the station being on the wrong side of the line, owing to which circumstance all passengers had to cross the rails, then pointed out the necessity that existed for an overway bridge or sub-way, owing to the crowded state of the yard at times during the day and night, and the large amount of shunting that was carried out. The crossing of the line under such circumstances was fraught with considerable danger and His Worship trusted that now the matter had been pointed out to the Commissioners the desired end would be attained.

Mr E. H. Limbert remarked that it had been suggested that the difficulty might be overcome by erecting a new station on the town-side of the line, and using the existing building for some other purpose.

Cr Callary, J.P., drew the Commissioners' attention to the badly lighted state of the yard at night and respectfully urged that a few more lights might be kept burning.

Cr Howard pointed out the necessity for ringing a bell five minutes before the departure of all passenger trains as, owing to the large number of goods trains leaving the station, the present arrangement was very confusing.

Mr Smith in reply said that the matters that had been brought under the notice of himself and colleagues would be carefully considered.

The Commissioners, accompanied by the railway officials, then inspected the station buildings and yard, leaving shortly afterwards for Terowie by the special train.

*Petersburg Times*  
Friday 8 June 1888

Petersburg was at last going to have a local court established in the town, and the corporation boundaries were to be enlarged to include the cemetery, which was still under control of the Yongala District Council.

